Soumitra Shukla

The Burning Glass Institute
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U.S. Permanent Resident

Current Positions:

Economist, The Burning Glass Institute (2025 - Present)

Other Affiliations:

Affiliate, Stone Center, University of Chicago (2026 - Present)
Affiliate, Yale University (2021 - Present)

Past Employment:

Research Fellow, HBS Artificial Intelligence Institute (2025 - 2026)
Economist, Federal Reserve Board (2021 - 2024)

Education:

Ph.D. in Economics (with Distinction), Yale University (2015 - 2021)
M.Phil. in Economics (with Distinction), Yale University (2015 - 2017)
B.S. in Economics and Mathematics (with Distinction), University of Minnesota (2010 - 2015)

Doctoral Qualifying Exams:

Labor Economics (with Distinction) and Industrial Organization

Research Fields:

Labor Economics, Organizational Economics, AI and the Future of Work

Working Papers:

Technology Bottlenecks: Measuring Where AI Could Raise the Value of Work It Cannot Yet Do

Pyramids, Diamonds, and Oscillations: AI and the Structure of Internal Labor Markets (with Guido Friebel, Yao Huang, Jin Li, and Andrew Zhang)

Interviews (with Jason Sockin and Elliott Ash)

Making the Elite: Caste, Class, and Cultural Capital in Multinational Hiring

In Progress:

The Childhood Socioeconomic Circumstances of U.S. Elites from 1750 to 2025 (with Paul Novosad, Dan Fetter, and Luke Stein)

Automation Speed as Equilibrium Selection (with Alex Imas, Maria del Rio-Chanona, and the Google DeepMind team)

Generative AI and the Structure of Scientific Creativity (with Prashant Garg)

Generative AI and the Reorganization of Innovation Work (with Prashant Garg)

Using LLMs to Map Job Transitions Under Technological Change
(with Mariya Pominova and Sofia Valdivia)

Hiring Under Technological Change (with Florian Englmaier, Nik von Hesler, Katia Molak, Raffaella Sadun, and Jorge Tamayo)

Essays and Other Writings:

Technological Progress and the Meaning of Work (with Alex Imas)

How Will AI-driven Automation Actually Affect Jobs? (with Alex Imas)

Who Uses AI (and How?): Tracking the Evidence on AI Adoption (with Alex Imas)

Fellowships, Honors and Awards:

2026 CFXS Best Idea Prize for "The Digital Gatekeeper", with Mariya Pominova and Sofía Valdivia Lucia Memorial Award, joint with Peyman Shahidi for "The Task and Skill Content of Jobs" (2026)
University Dissertation Fellowship, Yale University (2020 - 2021)
University Fellowship, Yale University (2015 - 2020)
Carl Arvid Anderson Prize Fellowship, Yale University (2019 - 2020)
Economic Growth Center Prize, Yale University (2015 - 2020)
Cowles Foundation Fellowship, Yale University (2015 - 2019)
Raymond Powell Prize for Teaching, Yale University (2018 - 2019)
Lester Page Hoole Fellow, Yale University (2017 - 2018)
Distinction in Labor Economics Oral Qualifying Exam, Yale University (2017)
Ella Thorp Scholarship, University of Minnesota (2014 - 2015)
Linda and Ted Johnson Research Fellowship, University of Minnesota (2014 - 2015)
Phi Beta Kappa (top 2% of class), University of Minnesota (2014)
Phi Kappa Phi (top 5% of class), University of Minnesota (2014)
Talle Family Scholarship, University of Minnesota (2013 - 2014)
Stockman Scholarship, University of Minnesota (2012 - 2013)
Undergraduate Research Opportunities Award, University of Minnesota (2012)
Meritorious Winner: Mathematical Contest in Modeling, University of Minnesota (2012)
University Honors Program, University of Minnesota (2011)

Research Grants:

Cowles Foundation Research Grant (2017 - 2021)

Invited Conferences and Talks*:

* including invited participation

2026: American Economic Association Annual Meeting, Berkeley Culture Connect, NBER Race and Stratification Working Group (Spring 2026), NBER Organizational Economics Working Group (Spring 2026), Cowles Labor and Public Economics Conference (Yale), NBER Summer Institute (Labor Studies), NBER Summer Institute (Frontier Econometric Methods), NBER Summer Institute (Personnel Economics), NYU Political Economy Seminar, MIT Organizational Economics Seminar, Quantitative Methods Workshop, University of Chicago, Stanford Labor Lunch, Management, Analytics, and Data (MAD) Conference at Columbia Business School, AI in the Workplace Conference, University of Chicago, Hoover Institution, Stanford, Advances with Field Experiments (AFE) 2026 Conference, University of Chicago, Oxford University, Cologne Summer School, CEPR IMO-ESF

2025: NBER Race and Stratification Working Group (Spring 2025), Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Georgetown University, NBER Organizational Economics Working Group (Spring 2025), NBER Economics of Culture and Institutions (Spring 2025), Cowles Labor and Public Economics Conference (Yale), NBER Summer Institute (Personnel Economics), NBER Summer Institute (Labor Studies), NBER Summer Institute (Frontier Econometric Methods), University of Utah, Brigham Young University, Emory University, MIT Organizational Economics Seminar, AI in Social Science Conference (Chicago Booth), NBER Organizational Economics Working Group (Fall 2025)

2024: System Equitable Growth Conference (New York Fed), DevSouth Workshop (University of Tennessee), System Applied Micro Conference (Chicago Fed), Cowles Labor and Public Economics Conference (Yale), Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago, Society for Economic Dynamics (Barcelona), NBER Summer Institute (Personnel Economics), NBER Summer Institute (Methods Lecture), Indeed Hiring Lab, People and Organizations Conference (Wharton), Research with and within Organisations (Mannheim), NBER Economics of Mobility Conference (Fall 2024),

U.S. Department of Education, Office of the Chief Economist, NBER Organizational Economics Working Group (Fall 2024), Harvard Business School

2023: Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop (University of Georgia), The Washington Area Labor Economics Symposium, Discrimination in the 21st Century (Chicago Booth and BFI), Cowles Labor and Public Economics Conference (Yale), Cowles Models and Measurement Conference (Yale), SITE Conference on Labor Markets and Policies (Stanford), SITE Conference on Gender (Stanford), NBER Economics of Mobility Conference (Fall 2023), SEA Meetings in New Orleans (Human Capital)

2022: Fed Applied Micro Junior (FAM Jr.) Workshop, AFE-EME Brown Bag Seminar, International Finance Workshop, Discrimination and Disparities Seminar, Discrimination in the 21st Century (Chicago Booth and BFI), Cowles Labor and Public Economics Conference (Yale), Barcelona GSE Summer Forum (Structural Micro)

2021: Chicago Fed, Federal Reserve Board of Governors, Wharton (Business Economics and Public Policy), Society of Labor Economists, Penn State (Economics of Education Seminar), International Banking and Finance Workshop, International Finance Workshop, FRB Research Webinars, UC San Diego (Program on the Indian Economy)

Journal Refereeing and Grant Reviews:

Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics, The Review of Economics and Statistics, Economics Letters, Labour Economics, National Science Foundation, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics

Programming Skills:

R (advanced), Julia (advanced), Stata (intermediate), Python (beginner)

References:

Prof. Joseph G. Altonji, Yale University, Department of Economics, joseph.altonji@yale.edu

Prof. Costas Meghir, Yale University, Department of Economics, c.meghir@yale.edu

Prof. John Eric Humphries, Yale University, Department of Economics, johneric.humphries@yale.edu

Dr. Jasper Hoek, Federal Reserve Board, Deputy Associate Director, jasper.hoek@frb.gov

Prof. Raffaella Sadun, Harvard Business School, Strategy Unit, rsadun@hbs.edu

Prof. Jorge Tamayo, Harvard Business School, Strategy Unit, jtamayo@hbs.edu

Prof. Paul Novosad, Dartmouth College, Department of Economics, paul.novosad@dartmouth.edu

Prof. Scott Kominers, Harvard Business School, skominers@gmail.com

Dr. Gad Levanon, The Burning Glass Institute, Chief Economist, glevanon@burningglassinstitute.org

Prof. Guido Friebel, Goethe University Frankfurt, gfriebel@wiwi.uni-frankfurt.de

Prof. Steven Durlauf, University of Chicago, sdurlauf@uchicago.edu